test-point, and the operator ought always to test any current first upon himself.

LOCAL ORGANIC DIAGNOSIS.

Irritation and paresis of organs are sought for, by placing the poles successively over them. Sensibility and contractility are increased with irritation; decreased with paresis. Of course, the current must be so directed as to traverse the organ examined. The former is sometimes spoken of as a positive state; the latter as negative, and they require the influence of opposite poles and currents; the former from the part, or through it; the latter, to it.

Local irritation, not very deeply seated, often displays, after a few minutes, circumscribed cutaneous redness; this is often seen upon the spine, after applying the sponge-electrode. (Electric currents applied through dry metal may produce similar evidences of irritation anywhere.)

SPINAL DIAGNOSIS.

The negative pole being at the feet; the positive, with sponge-electrode, on the spine; tender or insensible spots may be found. The former may be due to local trouble, easily obvious to examination by electricity—even with wet sponge—in the production of cutaneous redness. If the tenderness arises from other than local trouble, the cause will probably be discovered in the outlying viscera, etc.; as ascertained, for instance, by Keen's Flowers' Nerve Charts. Insensibility may also be either purely local, or sym-